

UNIT 3 / People and things

One book, two books

Your goal: Recognise common plural patterns and count familiar objects.

01 Learn the idea

German plurals do not follow one universal ending. Common patterns include -e, -er, -(e)n and -s, sometimes with an umlaut. Compare der Tisch/die Tische, das Buch/die Bücher, die Lampe/die Lampen and das Handy/die Handys. Learn the plural alongside each new noun.

Use Das ist for one thing and Das sind for several things. After a number greater than one, use the plural noun: zwei Bücher, drei Lampen. The number eins becomes ein before a masculine or neuter noun in the basic form: ein Buch. The plural article die does not mean every plural noun is feminine.

Words and phrases

German	English
zwei Bücher	two books
drei Lampen	three lamps
vier Tische	four tables
die Handys	the mobile phones
Das sind Stühle.	Those are chairs.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Wie viele Bücher sind hier?

How many books are here?

Ben

Drei Bücher und zwei Handys.

Three books and two mobile phones.

Mia

Und eine Lampe!

And one lamp!

Your real-life mission

Draw a desk with several objects. Write four captions with numbers and plural nouns, then describe the picture aloud.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “zwei Bücher” mean?

- A. two books
- B. three lamps
- C. four tables

2. What does “drei Lampen” mean?

- A. four tables
- B. three lamps
- C. the mobile phones

3. What does “vier Tische” mean?

- A. the mobile phones
- B. Those are chairs.
- C. four tables

4. Choose the plural of das Buch.

- A. die Buchs
- B. die Bücher
- C. die Buche

5. How many phones are in the dialogue?

- A. One
- B. Three
- C. Two

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - two books

“zwei Bücher” means “two books”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - three lamps

“drei Lampen” means “three lamps”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - four tables

“vier Tische” means “four tables”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - die Bücher

Buch forms Bücher with an umlaut and -er.

5. C - Two

Ben says zwei Handys.

One possible mission response

Hier sind drei Bücher, zwei Handys, vier Stühle und eine Lampe.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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